

General Knowledge

Static GK

STUDY NOTES

Defence Exercises



Defence Exercises

Defence exercises are critical for improving operational readiness, enhancing international cooperation, and testing new strategies and tactics. These exercises can be conducted on a bilateral, multilateral, or domestic level, depending on the scope and the number of participating countries.

Key Objectives of Defence Exercises:

- **Interoperability:** Improving cooperation and understanding between different military forces.
- **Readiness:** Ensuring that armed forces are ready for potential conflicts or peacekeeping missions.
- **Skill Development:** Enhancing the skills of troops in various combat scenarios and operational settings.
- **Strategic and Tactical Evaluation:** Testing new strategies and tactics in real-world scenarios.
- **Crisis Management:** Preparing forces to handle natural disasters, humanitarian crises, and counter-terrorism operations.

Significance of Defence Exercises for India:

- **Enhanced Defence Relations:** Joint exercises help strengthen defence ties between India and other nations.
- **Operational Efficiency:** Exercises improve India's readiness in various combat scenarios.
- **Global Influence:** Active participation in international military exercises demonstrates India's global presence and strategic importance.
- **Technological and Tactical Advancements:** Exposing Indian forces to advanced technologies and tactics used by other nations.

Types of Defence Exercises

- **Domestic Military Exercises:**

- **Purpose:** To enhance coordination between different branches of a nation's military and improve internal security readiness.
- **Participants:** Primarily involves the country's own armed forces (Army, Navy, Air Force).
- **Focus:** Internal security, counter-terrorism, disaster response, and war simulations.
- **Examples:**
 - **Gandiv Vijay:** Focuses on coordination between Indian armed forces.
 - **Vayu Shakti:** Tests the Indian Air Force's operational capabilities and defense systems.
 - **Vijay Prahar:** A major exercise that evaluates the Indian Army's battle readiness.
- **Bilateral Military Exercises:**
 - **Purpose:** To foster better relations and improve interoperability between two countries.
 - **Participants:** Two countries working together to improve operational cooperation, strategies, and tactics.
 - **Focus:** Counter-terrorism, joint combat skills, and sharing military expertise.
 - **Examples:**
 - **Desert Cyclone** (India - UAE): Enhances cooperation in desert warfare and counterterrorism.
 - **Ex Khanjar** (India - Kyrgyzstan): Focuses on mountain warfare and counterinsurgency.
 - **Tiger Triumph** (India - USA): A joint exercise to enhance maritime and land defense coordination.
 - **SADA TANSEEQ** (India - Saudi Arabia): Aims to improve bilateral military cooperation.
- **Multilateral Military Exercises:**
 - **Purpose:** Involve multiple countries working together to achieve common defense goals, improving coordination in large-scale operations.
 - **Participants:** Multiple countries (usually with several military forces involved).
 - **Focus:** Enhances regional or global security, counterterrorism, and peacekeeping.
 - **Examples:**

- **MALABAR Exercise** (India, USA, Japan, Australia): Focuses on maritime security and operational interoperability.
- **RIMPAC** (USA, Canada, Australia, India, Japan): The largest international maritime warfare exercise held in the Pacific.
- **Shangri-La Dialogue** (India, China, USA, ASEAN nations): A security and defense summit discussing regional security issues.
- **Vostok** (Russia, India, China): A multilateral exercise focusing on land and air operations.

Joint Military Exercises of India in 2024:

Exercise Name	Participants	Place Held	Duration
Desert Cyclone	India - UAE	Rajasthan, India	2nd Jan - 15th Jan 2024
Ex Cyclone-I	India - Egypt	Anshas, Egypt	22nd Jan - 1st Feb 2024
Ex Khanjar	India - Kyrgyzstan	Himachal Pradesh, India	22nd Jan - 3rd Feb 2024
SADA TANSEEQ	India - Saudi Arabia	Rajasthan, India	29th Jan - 10th Feb 2024
Dharma Guardian	India - Japan	Rajasthan, India	25th Feb - 9th Mar 2024
Samudra Laksmana	India - Malaysia	Visakhapatnam, India	28th Feb - 2nd Mar 2024
Tiger Triumph	India - USA	Kakinada, India	18th Mar - 31st Mar 2024

Ex LAMITIYE – 2024	India – Seychelles		18th Mar – 27th Mar 2024
Ex DUSTLIK – 2024	India – Uzbekistan	Termez, Uzbekistan	15th Apr – 28th Apr 2024
Exercise Cyber Suraksha	India –	Not Specified	20th May – 24th May 2024
Military Exercise SHAKTI	India – France	Umroi, Meghalaya, India	13th May – 26th May 2024
YUDH ABHYAS-2024	India – USA	Mahajan Field Firing Ranges, Rajasthan	9th Sept – 22nd Sept 2024
KAZIND-2024	India – Kazakhstan	Auli, Uttarakhand	30th Sept – 13th Oct 2024
VAJRA PRAHAR	India – US	Idaho, USA	[Date not provided]

Types of Joint Military Exercises of India

India's joint military exercises are categorized based on the number of participating countries and the nature of the drills. These exercises play a key role in enhancing India's defence capabilities, improving international relations, and refining operational skills. The three main categories are:

Domestic Military Exercises

- These exercises are designed for internal engagement, often involving the Indian Army, Navy, Air Force, and other military units.
- Domestic exercises are crucial for enhancing coordination within the country and are often used to simulate scenarios related to internal security, disaster response, and war readiness.
- **Examples of Domestic Exercises in 2024:**
 - **Gandiv Vijay:** Focuses on improving coordination between different branches of the Indian Armed Forces.
 - **Paschim Lehar:** A large-scale exercise focused on the Navy's operational capabilities and coastal security.
 - **Vayu Shakti:** A key air force exercise that aims to test India's air defence systems and operational readiness.
 - **Vijay Prahar:** An exercise aimed at testing the battle readiness of the Indian Army in diverse combat scenarios.

Bilateral Military Exercises

- Bilateral military exercises involve two countries and are conducted to improve operational interoperability, share strategies, and enhance mutual understanding of military tactics and resources.
- These exercises help strengthen defence cooperation and foster trust between nations.

Joint Exercises Conducted by the Indian Army

Exercise Name	Countries Participating
Ex AUSTRA HINDBAH	India, Australia
Ex SAMPRITI	India, Bangladesh
Ex HAND IN HAND	India, China

Ex SHAKTI	India, France
Ex GARUDA SHAKTI	India, Indonesia
Ex PRABAL DOSTYKK	India, Kazakhstan
Ex KHANJAR	India, Kyrgyzstan
Ex EKUVERIN	India, Maldives
Ex NOMADIC ELEPHANT	India, Mongolia
IMBEX	India, Myanmar
Ex SURYA KIRAN	India, Nepal
AL NAGAH	India, Oman
Ex INDRA	India, Russia
Ex LAMITIYE	India, Seychelles
Ex MITRA SHAKTI	India, Sri Lanka
Ex MAITREE	India, Thailand
Ex AJEYA WARRIOR	India, United Kingdom

Ex YUDHABHAYAS	India, United States
Ex VAJRA PRAHAR	India, United States

Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR) Operations (Indian Army)

Operation Name	Location	Description
Op Surya Hope	Uttarakhand	Search and rescue operations during the 2013 floods
Op Sankat Mochan	Jammu & Kashmir	HADR and rescue operations in the 2005 earthquake
Op Rahat	Jammu & Kashmir	Relief and rescue operations after the 2005 earthquake
Op Meghdoot	Siachen Glacier	HADR operations in extreme weather conditions (Siachen)
Op Vayu Shakti	Rajasthan	Large-scale military preparedness and HADR operations
Op Devta	Assam	Relief and rescue operations post-floods
Op Shakti	Gujarat	Assistance and relief operations in the aftermath of the 2001 Gujarat earthquake

Op Zafar	Jammu & Kashmir	Evacuation and relief operations during the 2014 floods
----------	-----------------	---

Major Exercises Conducted by the Air Force

Exercise Name	Description
Ex Veer Guardian	First Air Exercise between India and Japan
Ex PASSEX with France	Joint exercise with French fighter aircraft
Ex Desert Flag-8	First participation of Tejas in an international air exercise
Ex Cobra Warrior	Multinational Air Exercise
Ex Cope India	Joint exercise of India with USAF and Japan (observer)
Ex Orion	Multinational exercise
Ex INIOCHOS	First Air Exercise between India and Greece
Ex Bright Star	Joint exercise with Egypt

Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief Operations (Air Force)

Operation Name	Location	Description
Op Dost - Turkiye and Syria	Turkiye, Syria	Earthquake relief

Op Kaveri - Sudan	Sudan	Evacuation of Indian citizens
Op Ajay (Israel – Hamas Conflict)	Israel, Gaza	Medical and disaster relief

Integrated Exercises With Sister Services

Exercise Name	Description
Ex Kranti Mahotsav	01 Multi-Role Helicopter (MLH)
Ex Chakra Drishti	Fighter aircraft, Remotely Piloted Aircraft (RPA), and Airborne Early Warning & Control System (AEW&C) – Western Command Theatre
Ex Chakra Drishti	Helicopters, Transport aircraft, RPA, and Fighter aircraft
Ex Chakra Drishti	Long-Range Maritime Strike – Fighters, Transport aircraft, and AWACS (Airborne Warning And Control System)
MiG-29K Detachment at AFS Naliya	Joint detachment with Indian Navy's MiG-29K fighters

Joint Exercises Conducted by the Indian Navy

Exercise	Countries Participating
MALABAR	India, USA, Japan, Australia
Varuna	India, France

La Perouse	India, Australia, USA, France, Japan, United Kingdom
Sea Dragon	India, USA, Japan, Canada, South Korea
Konkan	India, UK
AIME & IMDEX	India, ASEAN Countries
Bright Star	India, 34 Countries
SALVEX	India, USA
SLINEX	India, Sri Lanka
Samudra Shakti	India, Indonesia
Al-Mohed Al-Hindi	India, Saudi Arabia
India - France - UAE trilateral exercise	India, France, UAE
India - France - UAE trilateral PASSEX	India, France, UAE
KOMODO	India, Multiple (36 Countries)
AUSINDEX	India, Australia
SIMBEX	India, Singapore

Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR) & Search and Rescue (SAR) Operations

Operation Name	Description	Location
Operation Kaveri	Evacuation of Indian nationals from Sudan	Red Sea
Operation Karuna	HADR to Myanmar (post-Cyclone Mocha)	Yangon, Myanmar
Brahmapuram Firefighting Assistance	Assisted local authorities in firefighting efforts at Brahmapuram solid waste treatment plant	Kochi, India

Multilateral Military Exercises (India's Participation)

Exercise Name	Countries Participating	India's Participation	Nature of Exercise
Shangri-La Dialogue	India, China, USA, Australia, Japan, ASEAN nations	Yes	Annual defense and security summit in Singapore.
MALABAR Exercise	India, USA, Japan, Australia	Yes	Naval exercise focusing on maritime security.
RIMPAC (Rim of the Pacific)	USA, Canada, Australia, Japan, India, New Zealand, several Pacific nations	Yes	The world's largest international maritime warfare exercise.

Vostok	Russia, China, India, and other CSTO countries	Yes	Military exercise in Russia involving land and air operations.
Peacekeeping Operations	UN, India, USA, France, UK, and other UN member states	Yes	Exercise focused on peacekeeping and humanitarian missions.
INDO-PACIFIC REGION (IPR)	India, Japan, Australia, USA	Yes	Maritime and joint security operations in the Indo-Pacific.

Multilateral Military Exercises (India Does Not Participate)

Exercise Name	Countries Participating	India's Non-participation Reason	Nature of Exercise
Talisman Saber	USA, Australia, Japan, New Zealand, Canada, others	India not part of this bilateral exercise	Large-scale joint exercise for enhancing combined forces' operations.
Bright Star	USA, Egypt, and other NATO countries	India does not participate in this annual exercise	Focuses on counter-terrorism and disaster relief missions.

Joint Warrior	UK, USA, NATO members	India not part of this exercise	Primarily focused on naval and land combat scenarios in the North Sea.
Cobra Gold	Thailand, USA, Japan, South Korea, Malaysia	India does not currently participate	One of the largest multilateral joint military exercises in Southeast Asia.
European Winds	European countries, USA, NATO members	India not involved	Primarily focused on land and air combat exercises.